phones, whenever a new mass technology has emerged, it has changed the nature of society and politics.[17]

For a long time, discussions on the impact of digital technologies on Indian politics have been on the margins of scholarly studies because of the perception of a digital divide—that such an impact was limited to a small section because the vast voting multitudes simply did not have access to the internet. While this may have been true in the past, the availability of cheap data on mass mobile telephony between 2016 and 2019 has caused the digital divide in India to shrink.

Figure 7.2: BJP Training Manual on Handling Media and Social Media, 2018



Source: BJP e-library. Available at: http://library.bjp.org/jspui/handle/123456789/2572